

Bursar dashboard: UI/UX audit

Huchu schools vertical audit · Bursar dashboard: UI/UX audit · bursar/ui-ux.md · rendered 2026-09-14

Surface: `app/schools/finance/**` and their content components `components/schools/fees/{fees-grade-picker,class-fees-content,schools-fees-content,fee-dialogs,bulk-generate-invoices-dialog,copy-structure-dialog,fee-status}.tsx`, `components/schools/reports/reports-arrears-content.tsx`, plus the fee tabs of `documents/school-documents-content.tsx`. Audited from source and from `docs/screenshots/schools/fees/*`, `finance-desktop/*`, `finance-phone/*`, `visual-pass-*/01-class-fees.png`. Workflow companion: `workflows.md` in this folder.

Rules applied: `docs/ux/platform-ux-playbook.md`, `docs/design-system/{05-rules,08-cookbook-patterns,12-tables}.md`, `09-campus-canvas-law.md`, `10-campus-screen-contract.md`, `11-campus-states-and-motion.md`, `.impeccable.md`, `SPEC.md`. The rule digest is in `../reference/docs-baseline.md §9` and `../reference/backoffice-ui-ux-evidence.md §0`.

1. Verdict in one paragraph

The bursar's screens have the best confirmation and reason-capture copy in the module ("£ 510.00 is unwound: every invoice this receipt settled goes back to owing. This cannot be undone.") and the receipt dialog's allocation logic is right. They fail on the surface in ways a bursar meets every hour. Row verbs on every fee screen are clipped off the right edge at desktop, tablet and phone widths because `RecordActions` is rendered inline, so "Take payment" reads "Tak". The landing page has no primary action; "Record receipt" is two screens away. The ledger on a phone spends the entire first screen on chrome and shows no invoice. Three surfaces compute ageing in three code paths with different bucket labels (they agreed on the seeded data, and disagreed in an earlier screenshot set). The bill's status vocabulary differs between the ledger and the students list. And the arrears and reports pages ship the designer's rationale as product copy.

Runtime check (14 September 2026)

Verified on the seeded St Marys tenant (see `../reference/runtime-verification.md`). Confirmed at runtime: 28 of 49 buttons on the class fees page sit past the right edge of a 1440px viewport ("Take payment", "Write off" clipped); the first invoice on the phone ledger sits at 973px, below an 844px screen; the rationale cards on arrears and reports render; the "Outstanding 29,910" chip has no currency; the bursar's sidebar shows Result sheets, Homework and Scheme of work. Corrected: the ageing surfaces agree on this data.

2. Screen-by-screen

Route	Component	Contract violations	Friction	Role awareness	Phone	Severity
<code>/schools/fees</code>	redirect to <code>/schools/finance</code>	Nav says Fees, URL says finance				P2

Route	Component	Contract violations	Friction	Role awareness	Phone	Severity
/schools/finance	fees-grade-picker.tsx	In-page PageHeading "Fees and finance" plus app-bar "Finance"; seven band chips including "Classes 0" beside "Year groups 6"; three band actions and no primary; year-group table in a card, not full bleed; the collected progress bar painted danger red; "Find a year group" search alone on its row	Rows are not visibly links; "Longest overdue" rows have no verb; "Send reminders" goes to all overdue with no preview of who	No useSchoolAccess ; reminder button not gated on the route's real permission	Six numeric columns will scroll sideways	P1
/schools/finance/class/[classId]	class-fees-content.tsx	PageHeading "Form 1 fees" plus bar "Year group"; paragraph repeating the band chip (:206); inline RecordActions "Take payment · Write off · Edit" stacked and clipped (:326-360); "Write off" as a solid red button on every unpaid row	Record a receipt from here is two clicks, the best path in the module, if the button were visible; no family-level payment; no running total of today	Verbs gated by RecordActions	Rows already card-shaped; verbs still clip	P0
/schools/finance/ledger?view=invoices	schools-fees-content.tsx (2,197 lines)	PageHeading "Fee ledger" with a caption repeating the chips (:1352-1357); each panel adds an h2 (fourth name); six filters with two native date inputs (:1461, :1472) and "Owing at least" without currency; "Showing the first 100 of 120" banner instead of the pager; a second search row; inline row verbs on invoices (:723), refunds (:994), waivers (:1137), structures (:1270) while receipts (:825) and credits (:925) correctly use layout="menu"	Two "Record receipt" primaries on the empty receipts view; no bulk issue for drafts; no saved views; no keyboard	CreateButton per view gated correctly	First invoice below the fold at 390×844; no mobileListRenderer so a nine-column table scrolls sideways	P0

Route	Component	Contract violations	Friction	Role awareness	Phone	Severity
...?view=receipts	same	Nine columns	Void confirm copy exemplary	gated	none	P1
...?view=credits, ...?view=refunds	same	Refund "Pay / Cancel" inline	Raising a refund from a credit lands on Credits while the refund lives on Refunds, with no link	gated	none	P2
...?view=waivers	same	Up to six inline buttons per row	Approve-now toggle in the form is good	gated	none	P1
...?view=structures	same	Inline verbs; "New fee sheet" vs tab "Fee structures" vs nav "Ledger and structures"	No preview before bulk generate	gated	none	P2
/schools/finance/arrears	reports-arrears-content.tsx	PageChrome with "Remind the N" primary (good); toFixed and toLocaleString for money; rationale cards "The missing verb" and "Why these buckets" rendered as UI (: 797-812)	No per-family "Take payment" from the row; family phone not on the row	useSchoolAccess used; button correctly disabled for BURSAR, which means the bursar cannot chase from here at all	none	P0 (copy leak)
/schools/reports (arrears tab)	schools-reports-enhanced-content.tsx	Chip "Outstanding 29,910" with no currency (: 715 , confirmed at runtime); the chart and chip agreed with the finance page on the seeded data but are computed separately; "The missing verb" and "What the screen cannot do" cards (: 1090) confirmed at runtime	Export in the band is good		none	P0 (copy leak)
/schools/documents (fee invoice tab)	school-documents-content.tsx	Title Case throughout; raw enum status printed	Receipt and statement have no tab; no batch print		none	P1

3. Screenshot findings

- **Finance overview (desktop).** Good: per-form billed, collected and outstanding with a bar and percentage; ageing list; longest-overdue list with "90d" in mono red; currency caption. Wrong: page named twice; seven chips; no primary; collected bars in red; rows not clickable; the search alone on a row.

- **Invoices.** Good: mono invoice numbers, \$ 510.00, 20 September 2026, status badges. Wrong: header, caption and bar all name the page; six filters with two mm/dd/yyyy inputs; "first 100 of 120" banner; a second search row; "Edit / Write off (red) / Print" inline per row with Print clipped; rows around 90px.
- **Arrears.** Good: "Remind the 75" in the bar; CSV and PDF export. Wrong: "Outstanding 29,910"; Title Case tabs; filters over two rows; the chart contradicting the chip; rationale cards; a second search below the chart.
- **Receipts.** Good: the empty-state sentence. Wrong: two "Record receipt" primaries while the view is empty (one once a receipt exists); table header, empty state and pagination all rendered; four filters including two native dates.
- **Finance phone (390×844).** No record visible on the first screen: five chips over three rows, a tab strip clipped mid-word, six stacked filters, the banner, the search at the bottom edge.
- **Class fees (desktop, tablet, phone).** Good: rows are the right shape (avatar, "Surname, First", mono invoice number, term, billed, outstanding, status). Wrong: three stacked verbs clipped at every width; red "Write off" per row; caption repeating the chip; bar title "Year group".

4. Rule violations that recur

Rule	Violation	Where
A page is named once	In-page heading plus bar title on overview, class, ledger	three screens
One primary in the bar	None on overview; two on the receipts view	two screens
Row verbs in a menu; one inline primary	Inline stacks clipped	five views
One control row, one search	Two search rows on the ledger and arrears	two screens
Money carries currency; dates as 3 June 2026	Chip without currency; toFixed; native dates	three screens
Never the same fact twice	Caption repeating chips; "Classes 0"	three screens
Colour marks what to stop on	Collected bar in red; "Write off" as a red button at rest	two screens
Strip explanatory copy	Rationale cards	arrears, reports
One status vocabulary	Ledger: Draft, Issued, Part paid, Paid, Written off, Voided; students list: Paid, Partial, Overdue	two screens
The first phone screen belongs to the records	No invoice above the fold	ledger
Ratios with a zero denominator render as "___"	"0%" on the dashboard fee panel	overview

5. Suggested edits

1. **Row verbs (P0).** layout="menu" on class-fees-content.tsx:326, schools-fees-content.tsx:723, 994, 1137, 1270, with one inline primary per row where the row has an obvious verb: "Take payment"

on an unpaid invoice, "Approve" on a submitted waiver, "Pay" on a requested refund. The receipts view already does this.

2. **One ageing (P1).** One endpoint, one bucket definition, one `AgeingStrip` component consumed by the overview, the reports page and the dashboard, so the three cannot drift again.
3. **Phone ledger (P0).** Drop `PageHeading`, drop the caption, keep two chips per view, put the six filters behind one "Filter" sheet with a count badge, use the `DataTable` pager instead of the banner, add a `mobileListRenderer` (two lines, balance on the right, chevron). That lands the first invoice near $y=300$.
4. **Currency and dates (P1).** `schools-reports-enhanced-content.tsx:715` through `formatSchoolMoney`; every `toLocaleString` and `toFixed` in the fee and report components through `lib/schools/format.ts`; native date inputs to the design-system picker (sheet on phone).
5. **Remove rationale cards (P0).** `reports-arrears-content.tsx:797-812`, `schools-reports-enhanced-content.tsx:1090-1100` to comments or docs.
6. **Landing primary (P1).** `PageChrome` with "Record receipt" opening `ReceiptFormDialog` with an `InvoicePicker`; year-group rows as links; a `...` on longest-overdue rows with "Take payment" and "Remind".
7. **Receipt dialog (P1).** Show "Outstanding on SFI-00120: \$ 510.00" under the picker; live "Balance after / Credit created" as the amount is typed; method as a labelled select defaulting to Cash; date via the picker; a "Print receipt" checkbox that fires the receipt document after save.
8. **Status vocabulary (P1).** `InvoiceStatusBadge` everywhere; "Overdue" as a filter chip (due date past and balance above zero), not a status.
9. **Bulk actions (P1).** Selection bar on invoices (issue drafts, print, remind), on structures (activate), on waivers (approve).
10. **Bulk generate preview (P2).** "This will raise 20 invoices totalling \$ 9,800" before confirm.
11. **Refund thread (P2).** After raising a refund, switch to `?view=refunds` and highlight the new row, or toast "Open refund RF-0007".
12. **Documents (P1).** Add receipt and statement tabs; batch statement by class; sentence case.

6. Proposed restructuring

- `/schools/finance` becomes the bursar's dashboard (see §7), with the year-group table below the hero.
- The ledger's six views stay as one route with `?view=`, but the filters collapse to the two that matter per view plus a sheet for the rest; saved views ("Owing over \$500 in Form 3", "Unfiscalised this week") as chips in the strip.
- A family view reached from any invoice or receipt: household, all children, balance, statement, receipts, reminders sent, calls logged.
- Reminders and calls live on the arrears row: "Remind" (send), "Log a call" (outcome and note, no send), "Take payment". The bursar must be able to use all three.
- Rename the nav band "Fees" and keep it as the bursar's first band with `preferredHomeHref = /schools/finance`.

7. Proposed new UI

Bursar dashboard (/schools/finance)

- Bar primary: Record receipt. Band chips: Outstanding, Overdue with family count, Collected this term %, Credit on account.
- Hero: Collected vs billed this term with a progress bar and "same day last term" delta.
- KPIs (two-up on phone): Today's takings with receipt count (link to receipts filtered to today); Draft invoices not issued (link to issue all); Receipts not fiscalised (link to the ZIMRA queue); Refunds awaiting payment.
- Year-group collection table with row links and a `...`.
- Panels: Ageing (the one component); Longest overdue with verbs; Recent receipts, printable; Payment-method mix this week for cash-up.
- Empty state on a new term: "No invoices raised for Term 3 yet" with "Bulk generate" as the verb.

Counter mode. A focused receipt screen for the office window: student or family search, outstanding invoices with amounts, amount and method, change due for cash, print on save, next family. One screen, keyboard-first, usable on a tablet.

Cash-up screen. Per cashier per day: opening float, receipts by method, counted cash, variance, deposit slip, close.

Reminder composer. Preview of who will receive it (name, child, balance, channel), template with merge fields, cost estimate for SMS, send, then delivery status on the arrears row.

Interaction patterns to add: command palette verbs ("Record receipt", "Go to arrears"), URL-synced filters and saved views, undo toast for discard, peek on the student in an invoice row, a date stepper for receipts by day, and route-level `loading.tsx` and `error.tsx` under `app/schools/finance`.

8. Accessibility

- Row verbs hidden by clipping are also unreachable to keyboard users who cannot see focus land off-screen; the menu fixes both.
- The red "Write off" button at rest has the same tone as an error; keep destructive tone for the confirm, neutral at rest.
- Money in a monospace face with slashed zeros is hard to read at 11px; keep tabular figures in the sans face for amounts and mono for references.
- Native date inputs announce in the browser's locale; the picker fixes the format and the announcement.